



Donation Policy

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VERSION 1.0

WARNING!

Information contained in this document is intended
for flight simulation purposes only.

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Purpose of Document

This document establishes the official Donation Policy for VATSIM Sub-Saharan Africa (VATSSA). It governs the acceptance, management, and expenditure of voluntary financial contributions made by members of the VATSSA community.

This policy has been developed to achieve the following objectives:

- Set out the principles under which donations are received and how funds are administered.
- Ensure transparency and accountability in the management of all divisional finances.
- Define the mutual expectations between the division and those who choose to contribute.
- Protect the integrity of the division by ensuring that donations confer no preferential treatment or influence.

This policy applies to all members of VATSSA, all members of staff, and any individual making a financial contribution to the division.

1. Control Pages

1.1. Document Identification

Type	Policy
Revision	01/2026
Issue Date	
Effective Date	
Prepared By	George Daniel Schoonraad
Approved By	Wian Saptouw – VATSSA1 (Division Director)
Next Review Due	1st January 2027
Identification	VATSSA_POL_ATC_Training_05-2026.pdf

1.2. Revision Records

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0	04/2026	Initial Policy Drafted	George Daniel Schoonraad

2. General Provisions

2.1. Applicability

This policy applies to all VATSSA members, all divisional staff, and any individual making a financial contribution to the division, regardless of their divisional affiliation. Members are responsible for familiarising themselves with the contents of this policy prior to making a contribution.

2.2. Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with this policy — including any breach of the donor obligations set out in Section 4 — may result in disciplinary action. The VATSSA Leadership Department retains full authority to enforce the provisions of this policy.

2.3. Changes

This policy is subject to periodic review and amendment. Amendments may be made by the VATSSA Leadership Department as required. Members will be expected to comply with the most current published version of this policy, which will be published at vatssa.com.

3. Financial Context

3.1. Why We Need Your Support

VATSSA is a volunteer-driven division of VATSIM, dedicated to providing a high-quality virtual air traffic control experience across the Sub-Saharan Africa region. Like any organisation operating digital infrastructure, the division incurs real and ongoing costs in order to deliver its services to members.

Our infrastructure includes cloud-based virtual servers, DNS and security services, and the ongoing development and maintenance of divisional platforms. We are actively working to minimize these costs wherever possible; however some expenditure remains unavoidable in order to maintain a reliable and professional service for our members.

These costs are met entirely through the goodwill of our members. No VATSIM body allocates a budget to cover divisional running costs, which means that without voluntary contributions from people who care about the community we have built, services may be impacted. We are grateful to every member who chooses to contribute.

3.2. How We Spend Your Money

VATSSA takes financial responsibility seriously. Before any expenditure is approved, staff are required to submit a formal funding request for central review. This ensures that every decision to spend donated funds is justified, transparent, and represents fair value for the division.

A funding request must include:

- A clear description of what the funds are needed for.
- The full cost involved.
- A breakdown of what the division will receive in return.
- Where applicable, a comparison of at least two service providers.
- Any relevant quotes, invoices, or agreements already in place.

This process applies to all divisional expenditure, whether recurring infrastructure costs or one-off items such as event support.

4. Making a Donation

4.1. How to Contribute

Donations can be made through the official VATSSA donation platform, details of which are available on the VATSSA website. By completing a donation, you confirm that you have read, understood, and accepted the terms set out in this policy.

4.2. What VATSSA Commits To

VATSSA believes transparency and integrity are essential to maintaining the trust of our community. In accepting your donation, VATSSA makes the following commitments:

- Funds will be used exclusively for divisional needs. No donation will be directed toward personal benefit or payment for voluntary work.
- All transactions are processed through the designated platform, providing an auditable record of income and expenditure.
- Any VATSSA member may request a summary of the division's annual finances, which will be shared upon such a request.
- Your personal information will never be shared or disclosed in connection with your donation.
- Donors will not receive any form of preferential treatment, elevated status, or special consideration within the division or otherwise.
- Any surplus funds will be retained and carried forward to support future operational needs.

4.3. What You Agree To

By donating to VATSSA, you acknowledge and accept the following:

- Your contribution is a voluntary act of goodwill. It does not entitle you to influence divisional decisions, policy, or appointments in any way.
- You will not reference your donation — publicly or privately — in a manner intended to pressure, influence, or gain favour with staff or fellow members.
- Your donation has no bearing on any disciplinary or conduct process conducted by a Supervisor or member of staff.
- You will not publicise the fact that you have donated through any forum, social media platform, or other public channel.
- All donations are final. Once processed, contributions cannot be refunded or recalled under any circumstances.

Note: *Breach of any of the above donor obligations may result in disciplinary action by the VATSSA Leadership Department.*

5. Authority

- This policy is enforced by the VATSSA Staff and authorised by the Division Director.
- Decisions made under this policy are final unless otherwise stated by VATSSA procedures.

6. Review and Amendments

- This policy is subject to periodic review to ensure continued relevance and effectiveness, or when otherwise requested by the Division Director.
- Amendments to this policy may be made by the VATSSA Leadership Department as required.
- Members will be expected to comply with the most current published version of this policy, published at vatssa.com.